

Connecticut AI Hiring Law Compliance Kit

Everything a Connecticut employer needs for the CART Act (Public Act 26-15):
the plain-English playbook, AEDT inventory, pre-use notice, adverse-decision letter,
human-review log, anti-bias testing plan, and WARN AI-attribution checklist.

September 2026 Edition

Disclaimer: This kit is general information, not legal advice. Employment-AI regulation is evolving; verify requirements against the current statute and consult licensed Connecticut employment counsel before acting.

Connecticut AI Hiring Law — Compliance Playbook

Connecticut CART Act — Employer Compliance Playbook

Law: Connecticut Artificial Intelligence Responsibility and Transparency Act (CART Act), Public Act 26-15 (Senate Bill 5), signed May 27, 2026. **This kit covers the employment provisions only** (the Act also regulates chatbots, frontier models, synthetic media, and minors' social media — out of scope here).

DISCLAIMER — NOT LEGAL ADVICE. This playbook is general information for HR and operations teams. It is not legal advice and does not create an attorney-client relationship. Connecticut's law is new, some provisions are untested, and your facts may differ. Consult Connecticut employment counsel before acting.

1. What this law is

Connecticut now regulates employers' use of **automated employment-related decision technology (AEDT)** — AI and algorithmic tools that materially influence hiring, promotion, discipline, firing, and similar decisions. It does this in three moves:

1. **Transparency duties** (effective Oct 1, 2027): tell applicants/employees when AEDT is used, what it does, and why an adverse decision happened.
2. **"AI is not a defense"** (effective Oct 1, 2026): you cannot dodge a discrimination claim by blaming the algorithm — but documented anti-bias testing counts in your favor.
3. **AI layoff disclosure** (effective Oct 1, 2026): mass-layoff notices must say whether AI drove the cuts.

There is **no private right of action** for the employment provisions — only the Connecticut Attorney General can enforce them, as unfair/deceptive trade practices under CUTPA. (Sources: Seward & Kissel, "Connecticut Enacts New AI Law Impacting Employers," Aug 31, 2026; DCI Consulting via JD Supra, "Connecticut's New AI Law: What Employers Need to Know.")

2. Timeline — the only dates that matter for employers

Date	What takes effect	Source
Oct 1, 2026	FEPA amendment: AEDT use is "not a defense" to a discrimination complaint; courts/CHRO may weigh anti-bias testing as a mitigating factor	JD Supra (Sewkis); Ogletree
Oct 1, 2026	WARN AI-attribution: federal WARN-covered employers must tell CT Dept. of Labor whether layoffs relate to AI or other technological change	Ogletree; paice.work (citing chaptered text §26)
Oct 1, 2027	AEDT deployer duties: pre-decision written notice, interaction disclosure, adverse-decision explanation; developer information-sharing duty	ComplianceHub.wiki; Sewkis
Dec 31, 2027	AG's 60-day cure window for AEDT violations expires	JD Supra ("patchwork" article); DCI Consulting

[UNVERIFIED — sources conflict: DCI Consulting states developer information-sharing obligations go live Oct 1, 2026; ComplianceHub and paice.work (citing the chaptered text, §§8–10) place them at Oct 1, 2027. Treat Oct 1, 2026 as the cautious planning date and confirm with counsel.]

3. Who is covered

- **Who:** employers **doing business in Connecticut that deploy AEDT in the state**, for employment decisions **affecting individuals in Connecticut**. (Source: Seward & Kissel.)
 - [UNVERIFIED — no size threshold found: no reviewed source states a minimum employee count for the AEDT provisions. Unlike the WARN provision (which piggybacks on federal WARN's 100-employee trigger), the AEDT duties appear to apply to any covered employer regardless of size. Confirm with counsel — do not assume you are too small to be covered.]
 - **WARN AI-attribution:** applies to employers already covered by the **federal** WARN Act — generally those with **100 or more employees** — when filing a plant-closing or mass-layoff notice. (Sources: Ogletree; ComplianceHub.)
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4. What counts as AEDT (and what doesn't)

AEDT = any technology that processes personal data using computational methods to produce outputs — predictions, recommendations, classifications, rankings, scores — used as a **"substantial factor"** in making or materially influencing an **employment decision**. (Source: Sewkis.)

Employment decisions covered: hiring, promotion, discipline, termination/discharge, renewal of employment, selection for training/apprenticeship, and other decisions affecting tenure, terms, privileges, or conditions of employment.

"Substantial factor" = a constraint, ranking, score, recommendation, classification, or other output that *meaningfully alters the outcome* of an employment decision involving a Connecticut individual. (This is broad and leaves room for interpretation — when in doubt, treat the tool as covered.)

Excluded — not AEDT: - Ordinary workplace tools (word processors, spreadsheets, data storage, spam/robocall filters, spellcheckers) *to the extent they don't drive employment decisions* - Systems used only incidentally to an employment decision - Purely descriptive, diagnostic, or statistical information not relied upon for decisions - Decisions causing only **nonmaterial** changes to duties, hours, or assignments - Decisions about workplace health and safety, scheduling/planning, or productivity monitoring

Practical test: if a human would have decided differently without the tool's output, it's probably AEDT. Resume screeners, video-interview scoring, promotion ranking tools, and algorithmic discipline/termination flags are the classic cases.

5. Your duties, in plain English

A. Starting Oct 1, 2027 — for AEDT deployed on or after that date

Duty 1 — Written pre-decision notice. Before any AEDT-influenced employment decision, give the affected applicant/employee written notice containing: 1. That AEDT is being used 2. The purpose of the technology and the employment decision involved 3. The technology's **trade name** 4. The **categories and sources** of personal data analyzed, and **how that data will be evaluated** 5. Employer **contact information** for further inquiries

Duty 2 — Interaction disclosure. Tell applicants/employees when they are interacting *directly* with AEDT (e.g., an AI interviewer), in plain language — unless it would be obvious to a reasonable person.

Duty 3 — Adverse-decision explanation. When an adverse decision results, provide: 1. A high-level statement of the **principal reasons** for the decision 2. The **AEDT's role** in the decision 3. The **type and source of data** used 4. An **opportunity to examine and correct** personal data

Duty 4 — Interactive inquiry channel. Maintain a way for applicants/employees to seek additional information (e.g., a monitored HR inbox — see template 03).

Trade-secret safe harbor: you may withhold genuine trade secrets, but you must say *what* you're withholding and *on what legal basis*. (Sources: ComplianceHub; JD Supra "patchwork" article.)

Vendor rule: AEDT developers/vendors must give you the information you need to meet these duties — or they can contractually assume the duties themselves. **Renegotiate your vendor contracts now** to nail down who discloses what, plus indemnification. (Sources: Sewkis; DCI Consulting.)

B. Starting Oct 1, 2026 — "AI is not a defense"

Connecticut's Fair Employment Practices Act now says expressly: **using AEDT is not a defense** to a discriminatory-practice complaint. You cannot beat a bias claim by pointing at the vendor's algorithm.

The carrot: courts and the Commission on Human Rights and Opportunities (CHRO) **may consider evidence of anti-bias testing or similar proactive efforts** as a mitigating factor — weighing the testing's quality, efficacy, recency, scope, results, and your response to the results. This is not a safe harbor, but it is a real incentive to test now, before the 2027 duties bite. (Sources: Ogletree; Sewkis; WilmerHale.)

C. Starting Oct 1, 2026 — WARN AI-attribution

If you file a federal WARN notice (plant closing / mass layoff) with the Connecticut Department of Labor, you must disclose **whether the reductions are related to your use of artificial intelligence or another technological change**. Coordinate HR, legal, and operations now on how you document the rationale for workforce reductions. (Sources: Ogletree; paice.work §26.)

D. What the law does NOT require

- **No human-review / appeal right.** Unlike Colorado's AI law, CART does **not** give applicants a right to human reconsideration of an AEDT decision. (Source: ComplianceHub.) The human-review log in this kit (file 05) is a *recommended governance practice* — it strengthens your anti-bias-testing evidence — not a statutory duty.

- **No risk assessment or formal AI governance program** for employment AEDT (a deliberate contrast with Colorado). The law's center of gravity is transparency, not internal documentation. (Source: ComplianceHub.)
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6. Penalties and enforcement

- **Who enforces:** the **Connecticut Attorney General exclusively**, treating violations as unfair or deceptive trade practices under the **Connecticut Unfair Trade Practices Act (CUTPA)**. No private lawsuits under the employment provisions. (Sources: Sewkis; DCI Consulting.)
 - **Cure period:** for violations occurring **on or before December 31, 2027**, the AG must give a **60-day opportunity to cure** before suing. After that, no guaranteed cure. (Sources: JD Supra "patchwork"; DCI Consulting.)
 - **Penalty scale:** CUTPA's general framework allows courts to impose **civil penalties of up to \$5,000 per willful violation** (and \$25,000 for restraining-order violations), plus actual/punitive damages, costs, and attorney's fees (Conn. Gen. Stat. § 42-110a et seq., per CT General Assembly fiscal analysis). [UNVERIFIED as applied to CART: no reviewed source states AEDT-specific dollar penalties; the figures above are CUTPA's general ceilings.]
 - Separately, the **"AI is not a defense"** amendment plugs into existing FEPA discrimination liability — the exposure there is ordinary employment-discrimination exposure, which the amendment makes harder to deflect.
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7. Your 90-day action plan

Days 1–14 — Inventory (use file 02). List every tool touching hiring, promotion, discipline, termination, scheduling-adjacent decisions. For each: vendor, use case, data inputs, who owns it. Flag anything producing scores, rankings, or recommendations a human relies on.

Days 15–30 — Classify. For each inventoried tool, decide: AEDT or not, using Section 4 above. Document the reasoning — this memo is itself evidence of good faith.

Days 31–45 — Vendors. Send every AEDT vendor a written request: (a) the data categories, sources, and logic description you need for the 2027 notices; (b) their bias-testing documentation; (c) a contract amendment allocating disclosure duties and indemnification. (Use file 03's vendor-request insert.)

Days 46–60 — WARN readiness (Oct 1, 2026 is here). If you have 100+ employees: add the AI-attribution determination to your layoff-notice workflow now (file 07). Brief the executives who approve RIFs.

Days 61–75 — Bias testing (file 06). Run a first-pass anti-bias test on your highest-risk tool (usually the resume screener). Document methodology, results, and remediation — this is the evidence courts/CHRO may weigh.

Days 76–90 — Notices and logs. Draft your pre-decision notice and adverse-decision explanation templates (files 03–04), stand up the inquiry inbox, and start the human-review log (file 05) as standard practice.

8. FAQs

We bought the tool from a vendor — isn't compliance their problem? No. The duties sit on *you* as the deployer. The vendor must supply information (or contractually assume the duties), but the obligation to the applicant/employee is yours. (Source: Sewkis.)

We only use AI to schedule interviews. Covered? Decisions about scheduling and planning are expressly excluded. But if that same tool also *ranks* candidates, the ranking function is covered. Assess function by function.

Does this apply to our remote workers outside Connecticut? The law covers employment decisions affecting *individuals in Connecticut*. Out-of-state decisions are outside its stated scope. (Source: Sewkis.)

We deployed our screening tool in 2024. Do the 2027 duties apply? The deployer duties apply to AEDT *deployed on or after October 1, 2027*. [UNVERIFIED — edge case: sources do not clearly address material upgrades or re-deployments of pre-existing tools. Treat significant updates as re-deployment for planning purposes and confirm with counsel.]

Can applicants sue us directly for a missing notice? No — no private right of action for the employment provisions. But the AG can, and the FEPA "not a defense" amendment affects ordinary discrimination suits. (Sources: Sewkis; DCI Consulting.)

Sources

1. Seward & Kissel LLP, "Connecticut Enacts New AI Law Impacting Employers" (Aug 31, 2026) — <https://www.sewkis.com/insights/connecticut-enacts-new-ai-law-impacting-employers/>
2. DCI Consulting via JD Supra, "Connecticut's New AI Law: What Employers Need to Know" — <https://www.jdsupra.com/legalnews/connecticut-s-new-ai-law-what-employers-5846048/>
3. JD Supra, "Connecticut Enacts New AI Law Impacting Employers" (Sewkis reprint) — <https://www.jdsupra.com/legalnews/connecticut-enacts-new-ai-law-impacting-3276400/>
4. JD Supra, "The Growing Patchwork of State AI Laws: What It Means for Employers" — <https://www.jdsupra.com/legalnews/the-growing-patchwork-of-state-ai-laws-7690612/>
5. JD Supra, "Connecticut Takes Aim at AI in Employment Decisions With SB 5" — <https://www.jdsupra.com/legalnews/connecticut-takes-aim-at-ai-in-6344339/>
6. Ogletree Deakins, "New Connecticut Law Restricts Employer AI Use, Mandates Notice for AI-Caused RIFs" — https://ogletree.com/wp/wp-admin/admin-post.php?action=get_pdf&pid=88825
7. ComplianceHub.wiki, "Connecticut's CART Act: SB5 AI law explained" — <https://compliancehub.wiki/connecticut-cart-act-sb5-comprehensive-ai-law-2026/>
8. paice.work, "Connecticut AI Responsibility Act: What Starts October 1" — <https://paice.work/blog/connecticut-ai-responsibility-act-october-1>
9. WilmerHale, "What Companies Should Know About Connecticut's New Omnibus AI Law" — <https://www.wilmerhale.com/api/sitecore/module/pdfgeneration?itemurl=%2fen%2finsights%2fblogs%2fwilmerhale-privacy-and-cybersecurity-law%2f20260604-what-companies-should-know-about-connecticuts-new-omnibus-ai-law&itemid=%7bdef69819-878d-43c3-a6e8-caf647fd9bd9%7d>
10. CT General Assembly fiscal analysis (CUTPA penalty framework, CGS § 42-110a et seq.) — <http://cga.ct.gov/2023/fc/pdf/2023SB-01058-R000676-FC.pdf>

Template A — Pre-Use Notice to Candidates & Employees

Pre-Decision AEDT Notice — Template

DISCLAIMER — NOT LEGAL ADVICE. Adapt to your facts and have Connecticut employment counsel review before use. Required for AEDT deployed on or after **October 1, 2027** (CT CART Act, PA 26-15). Provide **before** the employment decision is made.

NOTICE OF USE OF AUTOMATED EMPLOYMENT DECISION TECHNOLOGY

Date: [DATE]

To: [APPLICANT / EMPLOYEE NAME]

From: [COMPANY NAME], [HR CONTACT NAME, TITLE] Contact for questions: [EMAIL] | [PHONE]

1. What this notice is. [COMPANY NAME] uses automated employment-related decision technology ("AEDT") as part of its [hiring / promotion / discipline / termination / ____] process. Connecticut law (Public Act 26-15, the CART Act) requires us to give you this written notice before we make a decision in which the technology plays a substantial role.

2. The technology. - Trade name: [TRADE NAME OF TOOL] - Vendor/developer: [VENDOR NAME] - Purpose: [e.g., "to rank applicants for the [ROLE] position based on predicted job fit" — one or two plain-English sentences]

3. The decision involved. [Describe the employment decision — e.g., "whether to advance your application to the interview stage for the [ROLE] position."]

4. Personal data analyzed. Categories of data the tool analyzes: - [e.g., information from your resume/application: work history, education, skills] - [e.g., assessment responses] - [ADD / DELETE rows as needed]

Sources of that data: - [e.g., materials you submitted; our applicant tracking system; ____]

How the data is evaluated: - [Plain-English description — e.g., "The tool compares your profile against patterns from past successful hires and produces a fit score from 1–100. Scores above 70 are advanced to human review." Get this language from your vendor.]

5. Human involvement. [A human recruiter/hiring manager reviews the tool's output before any final decision. / Describe actual workflow — do not overstate human review.]

6. Your right to ask questions. If you have questions about this technology or this notice, contact [HR CONTACT] at [EMAIL/PHONE]. [If you maintain an interactive inquiry channel, describe how to use it here.]

7. [IF APPLICABLE — trade-secret withholding.] Certain technical details of [TRADE NAME] are withheld as the vendor's trade secrets under [LEGAL BASIS]. What is being withheld: [describe generally, e.g., "the precise weighting formula of the scoring model"].

Record-keeping: retain a copy of each notice sent, with date and recipient, for at least [3] years. [UNVERIFIED — no reviewed source states a CART-specific retention period; 3 years is a recommended practice. Confirm with counsel.]

Template B — Adverse-Decision Explanation Letter

Adverse-Decision Explanation — Template

DISCLAIMER — NOT LEGAL ADVICE. Adapt to your facts and have Connecticut employment counsel review before use. Required when an adverse employment decision results from AEDT use, for tools deployed on or after **October 1, 2027** (CT CART Act, PA 26-15).

EXPLANATION OF EMPLOYMENT DECISION INVOLVING AUTOMATED TECHNOLOGY

Date: [DATE]

To: [APPLICANT / EMPLOYEE NAME]

From: [COMPANY NAME], [HR CONTACT NAME, TITLE] Contact for questions: [EMAIL] | [PHONE]

Re: [Position applied for / employment action — e.g., "Application for [ROLE]"]

Decision. After review, we have decided [not to advance your application / not to select you for promotion to [ROLE] / to terminate employment effective [DATE] / ____].

Principal reasons. The principal reasons for this decision were: 1. [e.g., "Your fit score of 62 did not meet our advancement threshold of 70."] 2. [e.g., "The hiring manager's assessment following the screening stage."] 3. [ADD / DELETE — list the actual principal reasons; do not list reasons that did not drive the decision.]

Role of automated technology. [TRADE NAME OF TOOL] ([VENDOR]) was used as a substantial factor in this decision in the following way: [e.g., "The tool scored all applicants and produced the ranked list from which interviewees were selected. A human recruiter reviewed the ranked list and made the final advancement decisions."]

Data used. The technology analyzed the following types of personal data, from these sources: - Data types: [e.g., resume content, assessment answers] - Sources: [e.g., your application materials; our applicant tracking system]

Your right to examine and correct data. If you believe any personal data used in this decision was incorrect, you may request to examine and correct it by contacting [HR CONTACT] at [EMAIL/

PHONE] within [30] days of this notice. [Describe the process: what to send, where, and what happens next.]

Questions. Contact [HR CONTACT] at [EMAIL/PHONE].

Do not use this template to paper over a discriminatory motive — the CART Act expressly provides that AEDT use is "not a defense" to a discrimination claim under Connecticut's Fair Employment Practices Act. If the real reason for the decision differs from what the tool output, say so accurately or do not send the notice until counsel reviews.

Record-keeping: retain a copy with date and recipient for at least [3] years. [UNVERIFIED — no reviewed source states a CART-specific retention period; 3 years is a recommended practice. Confirm with counsel.]

Anti-Bias Testing Plan (8-Week Program)

Anti-Bias Testing Plan — Step by Step

DISCLAIMER — NOT LEGAL ADVICE. The CART Act does not mandate a specific testing methodology. What it does: effective **Oct 1, 2026**, Connecticut's Fair Employment Practices Act provides that AEDT use is "not a defense" to a discrimination complaint — but courts and the CHRO **may consider evidence of anti-bias testing** (quality, efficacy, recency, scope, results, and your response) as a mitigating factor. This plan builds that evidence. Have counsel review the plan and keep results privileged where appropriate.

Why test now

The disclosure duties start Oct 1, 2027, but the liability shift starts Oct 1, 2026. Testing you do *this quarter* is the evidence a court may weigh later. (Sources: Ogletree; Sewkis.)

Step 1 — Pick the tool (Week 1)

Start with your **highest-risk AEDT**: usually the resume screener or whatever makes the most reject/advance calls. One tool per testing cycle. Record it in file 02 (inventory), column `testing_status`.

Step 2 — Define the decision and the population (Week 1)

Write down, in one paragraph: - The exact decision the tool influences (e.g., "advance to interview for hourly warehouse roles") - The population it was applied to in the last 6–12 months (dates, requisition IDs) - The tool's output scale (e.g., score 1–100, threshold 70)

Step 3 — Pull the data (Weeks 2–3)

From your ATS/HRIS, export for each candidate in the population: - Tool output (score/rank/recommendation) and the threshold applied - Final human decision (advanced / rejected) - Available demographic fields **as voluntarily provided** (race, sex, age band) — never infer demographics; use only what candidates disclosed, and consult counsel on data handling

[UNVERIFIED — best practice, not statute: the CART Act prescribes no testing methodology. The approach below mirrors the four-fifths rule commonly used in US employment testing.]

Step 4 — Run the disparity screen (Week 4)

For each demographic group with a meaningful sample size: 1. Compute the **selection rate** = advanced ÷ total per group 2. Compute the **ratio** = each group's rate ÷ highest group's rate 3. Flag any ratio **below 0.80** (the "four-fifths rule") for deeper review

Also check: does the tool systematically down-rank any group at *specific score bands*? Averages can hide cliffs.

You do not need fancy software — a spreadsheet pivot table does this. If you have a statistician or an I-O psychologist, use them; if not, document exactly what you did.

Step 5 — Investigate flags (Weeks 5–6)

For each flagged disparity: - Is a specific input driving it (e.g., employment gaps, zip code, name-derived features)? Ask your vendor for feature-importance information — they owe you cooperation under the Act's developer duties. - Is the disparity job-related and consistent with business necessity? Write down the analysis. - Could a less discriminatory alternative achieve the goal (different threshold, blinded inputs)?

Step 6 — Remediate and document (Week 7)

For each finding, record: **finding** → **action taken** → **owner** → **date**. Actions may include re-thresholding, removing an input, adding human review at a score band, or replacing the tool. "No action — disparity not found" is a valid outcome; write it down anyway.

Step 7 — File the evidence pack (Week 8)

Keep in one place, dated and versioned: 1. This plan (which tool, which population, which dates) 2. Methodology memo (what you computed and why) 3. Results tables 4. Remediation log 5. Vendor correspondence

This pack is what you'd hand counsel if the CHRO ever asks about "quality, efficacy, recency, scope" of your testing.

Step 8 — Repeat on a cadence

- **Re-test** each production AEDT at least **annually**, and after any material model, threshold, or vendor change. [UNVERIFIED — cadence is recommended practice; the Act sets no re-testing schedule.]
- **Log human overrides** continuously in file 05 — a pattern of overrides in one direction is itself a bias signal.

If you find a serious disparity

Stop and call counsel before changing anything in production. Remediation done wrong (e.g., secret race-conscious adjustments) can create its own liability. The goal is a *documented, job-related, consistently applied* process — not a particular statistical outcome.

WARN Act AI-Attribution Checklist (Effective Oct 1, 2026)

WARN Act AI-Attribution Checklist

DISCLAIMER — NOT LEGAL ADVICE. Effective **October 1, 2026**. Have Connecticut employment counsel review your notice before filing.

The rule

Connecticut's CART Act (PA 26-15, §26) requires that when an employer files a plant-closing or mass-layoff notice under the **federal** Worker Adjustment and Retraining Notification (WARN) Act with the Connecticut Department of Labor, the notice must disclose **whether the reductions are related to the employer's use of artificial intelligence or another technological change**.

(Sources: Ogletree; paice.work, citing chaptered text.)

Connecticut is one of the first states to formally link layoff reporting to AI-driven automation.

(Source: JD Supra, "Connecticut Takes Aim at AI in Employment Decisions With SB 5.")

Who this hits

Employers covered by **federal WARN** — generally those with **100 or more employees** — filing a covered plant closing or mass layoff notice. If you are not WARN-covered, this specific duty does not apply to you (but the Oct 1, 2026 "AI is not a defense" amendment still does).

Checklist — do this before your next RIF

- ☐ **Name the decision-maker(s).** Identify who approved the RIF and what materials they relied on (headcount models, workforce-planning tools, automation ROI analyses).
- ☐ **Ask the AI question explicitly.** Did any AI or algorithmic tool — workforce-planning software, productivity analytics, automation assessments, generative-AI efficiency projections — inform *which* roles, teams, or locations were cut? Document the answer in writing, even if the answer is "no."
- ☐ **Distinguish "AI-related" from "tech change."** The statute covers both "artificial intelligence" and "another technological change" (e.g., a software-driven reorganization, offshoring enabled by automation). If either contributed, the disclosure obligation is triggered.

- ☐ **Draft the disclosure sentence.** Example: "*The workforce reductions described in this notice are [related / not related] to the employer's use of artificial intelligence [and/or other technological change].*" If related, add one factual sentence describing the connection (e.g., "following deployment of automated customer-service systems, the Company eliminated X roles").
- ☐ **Coordinate HR + legal + operations.** The rationale for the RIF must be consistent across the WARN notice, internal communications, and any severance materials. Inconsistencies become exhibits.
- ☐ **Preserve contemporaneous documentation.** Keep the analyses and meeting notes supporting the stated cause. The state now has a statutory hook to ask *why* people were laid off.
- ☐ **File on time.** This is an addition to your existing WARN obligations, not a replacement — the federal 60-day notice clock still runs.

Common trap

A RIF "caused by" a reorganization that was itself *designed around* AI-driven productivity gains is arguably AI-related. When in doubt, disclose and describe — the statute asks *whether* there is a relation, and a transparent "yes, here is how" beats a "no" that discovery later contradicts.